

## BlueCart Tablet Checkout: UX Research Findings

Prepared by the BlueCart UX Research Team | Q4 2026 Follow-up Study

### Executive Summary

This follow-up study examines the tablet checkout experience at BlueCart, completing the trio of platform

studies launched earlier in 2026. Tablet currently accounts for 14% of BlueCart sessions but only 9% of

completed transactions, suggesting a meaningful gap between intent and conversion on this form factor.

Sessions revealed that tablet shoppers behave less like desktop users than the team had assumed: they

hold the device in lap or couch postures, scroll generously, and often disengage from elements anchored

at the top of the viewport. We identified five findings and recommend a corresponding set of changes for

the next release cycle.

### Methodology

We conducted moderated, task-based usability sessions with 15 participants over a four-week period in

October and November 2026. Participants were recruited through an external panel and screened to

confirm they had completed at least two online purchases on a tablet in the prior 90 days. Nine participants

identified as women and six as men; ages ranged from 28 to 64. Devices split across iPad (10), Samsung

Galaxy Tab (3), and Microsoft Surface (2), with a mix of orientations observed during natural use.

Each 50-minute session was conducted remotely, with participants screen-sharing from their personal

tablet via a secondary device. We deliberately asked participants to begin in their typical posture (couch,

bed, kitchen counter) to capture realistic ergonomics. Tasks included building a multi-item cart, applying a

promo code, correcting an intentionally invalid shipping address, and completing checkout. We used a

think-aloud protocol and recorded gaze direction and scroll behavior where possible. Two reviewers

affinity-mapped the transcripts; findings were prioritized by frequency across participants and by severity.

### Findings

Finding 1: Users scrolled past above-the-fold CTAs and engaged only when the CTA was anchored near the order total

Across both review-page variants tested, eleven of fifteen participants scrolled past the "Place Order"

button when it was positioned above the fold near the page header, and instead engaged with the CTA

only after it appeared below the itemized order summary, adjacent to the final total.

Scroll-tracking

confirmed that participants consistently moved the viewport down to verify line items and the calculated

total before considering the action button. Participants in landscape orientation, particularly on larger

iPads, were most affected: the upper CTA fell outside their natural gaze path entirely.

Time-to-tap was

38% lower in the below-the-fold variant.

“I didn’t even see the button up top — I was looking at my cart total. Once I saw the total at the bottom and the button was right there, I just tapped it.” — P05, 41, frequent tablet shopper

Finding 2: Inline error messages appear too late and in low-contrast type

When participants entered an invalid shipping address or mistyped a card number, the validation error

appeared only after they tapped “Continue,” and was rendered in a muted gray-red (#B85C5C) below the

offending field. Nine of fifteen participants tapped “Continue” two or more times before noticing the

message. Four participants assumed the page was frozen or the network had failed. The combined effect

of late timing and low contrast meant the error itself became a source of friction rather than a recovery aid.

“I kept tapping the button thinking it was broken. I didn’t see the little message until the third try. It needs to actually grab my attention.” — P09, 33, occasional tablet shopper

Finding 3: Quantity steppers and option pickers are sized for desktop, not touch

Quantity adjustment buttons and option dropdowns inherit desktop dimensions (approximately 24px) rather

than the 44px minimum recommended for touch. Eight participants mis-tapped at least once when

adjusting quantity, and three accidentally removed an item when attempting to decrement.

Mis-taps were

concentrated in lap and reclined postures, where hand stability was lower than at a desk.

“My finger keeps hitting the wrong thing. I had to zoom in just to change this from two to one.

On my phone the buttons are way bigger.” — P02, 56, frequent tablet shopper

Finding 4: On-screen keyboard obscures form fields during data entry

When participants tapped into the card number, expiration, or CVV fields, the on-screen keyboard

occluded the active field on seven of the ten iPads tested in landscape orientation. The page did not

auto-scroll to keep the field in view. Six participants typed without being able to see what they were

entering, and three made entry errors as a result.

"I literally cannot see what I'm typing right now. The keyboard is covering the field. I'm just hoping I got the numbers right." — P12, 47, occasional tablet shopper

Finding 5: Guest checkout is harder to find on tablet than on phone

The tablet sign-in screen presents account creation and sign-in as primary actions side-by-side, with guest

checkout demoted to a small secondary link in the lower-right corner. Five of the seven first-time users in

the study did not initially see the guest option and attempted to back out of checkout. The horizontal layout,

which works on phone where the link sits directly below the main buttons, breaks down at tablet width.

"Where's the 'just buy it' option? I always do guest checkout. I had to look for like thirty seconds before I spotted that tiny link in the corner." — P14, 29, frequent tablet shopper

Recommendations

The recommendations below map to the findings above and are scoped to be independently testable in the

next two release cycles.

Anchor the primary CTA below the order summary on tablet. Move "Place Order" to sit directly below

the total line, matching the natural gaze and scroll path observed across participants. Validate with a

follow-up A/B test on production traffic.

Surface validation errors immediately and at higher contrast. Validate fields on blur rather than on

submit, raise the error color to WCAG AA contrast on white, and add an icon to the left of the message.

Consider a brief shake or border highlight to draw attention.

Resize touch targets to a 44px minimum across checkout. Audit quantity steppers, dropdowns, and

option pickers for touch-target compliance and increase spacing between adjacent controls.

Auto-scroll active fields into view above the on-screen keyboard. Detect keyboard appearance and

scroll the focused field to roughly 30% from the top of the visible viewport. Test specifically in landscape on

10.9-inch and 12.9-inch iPads.

Promote guest checkout to a primary action on tablet sign-in. Restructure the sign-in screen so guest

checkout is one of two equally-weighted primary buttons, with account creation as a post-purchase

prompt.

Next Steps

We propose sequencing the CTA-placement and error-handling experiments first, as they target the

highest-frequency friction points. Findings 3, 4, and 5 can be implemented behind feature flags within the next sprint. Full session recordings, the affinity map, and screening data are available in the research repository.